L Learners Coach

Cheat sheet

From the free DoT learner driver manuals. Check with your testing centre for changes.

Read a sign in one second

- Blue disc: you MUST.
- Red ring with a line: you must NOT.
- Red ring, no line, a number: a LIMIT. Do not go over it.
- Triangle pointing UP: danger ahead.
- Triangle pointing DOWN: give way.
- Blue rectangle: RESERVED for the vehicle shown.
- Red diagonal cross over a sign: the rule has ENDED.
- Yellow background: a temporary sign, usually road works.

Lines on the road

- Red lines stop you stopping. Yellow lines stop you parking.
- Solid line on your side: do not cross. Broken: cross only to overtake or turn.
- Short dashes: same direction. Long dashes: oncoming traffic.
- Yellow box: never stop inside it.

The distance ladder

- Climb the ladder: hydrant 1.5 m, intersection 5 m (no parking), bridge or tunnel 6 m, pedestrian crossing 9 m (no stopping).
- Lights: switch on if you cannot see 150 m. Main beam reaches 100 m, dipped beam 45 m.
- Warning triangle: 45 m behind. Hooter: heard at 90 m. Number plate: read at 20 m.
- Towing with a rope: no more than 3.5 m apart, a red flag over 1.8 m, and no faster than 30 km/h.

Speeds

- 60, 100, 120: town, open road, freeway.
- 80 for heavy goods vehicles over 9 000 kg. 100 for buses and minibuses.
- 30 in a residential area (woonerf). 15 in a pedestrian priority zone.

Controls

- Sharp turn: every number EXCEPT 6 and 9 (indicator and fuel tank).
- No handbrake on a bike: the rear brake (7) holds it still. Sudden stop: both brakes, 4 and 7.

Who goes first

- 4-way stop: first to stop, first to go.

- Roundabout: give way to traffic from your right.
- A traffic officer beats every light and sign.
- Emergency vehicle with siren and lights: give way at once.

Dates and deadlines

- Learner's licence: 24 months. Licence disc: 12 months, plus 21 days grace.
- Accident: report to the police within 24 hours. Change of address: 14 days.

Numbers to memorise

24 months	Learner's licence is valid
12 months	Vehicle licence disc is valid
17 years	Minimum age for a car (light motor vehicle) learner's licence
60 / 100 / 120	km/h: urban / outside urban / freeway
80 km/h	Goods vehicle over 9 000 kg outside urban areas
30 km/h	Residential area; max towing speed without a solid bar
15 km/h	Pedestrian priority zone
5 to 8 s	How often to check all mirrors
500 m	Distance a 'no overtaking' sign applies
9 m	No stopping this close to a pedestrian crossing
6 m	No stopping near a tunnel, subway, bridge or narrow road
5 m	No parking this close to an intersection
1.5 m	No parking this close to a fire hydrant
1 m	From the road edge when parking outside urban areas
450 mm	Max from the edge when parked on the right of a one-way road
150 m	Lights on if you can't see this far; clear view needed to use the shoulder; animal warnings
100 m / 45 m	Main beam reach / dipped beam reach
20 m	Number plate readable
12 m	Parked near a lit street lamp: no lights needed
90 m	Hooter must be audible
45 m	Warning triangle behind a broken-down vehicle
2 s / 3 s	Minimum following distance: car or motorcycle / heavy vehicle
21 days	Grace period after the licence disc expires
14 days	Report a permanent change of address
30 m	Indicators and stop lamps visible in daylight
3.5 m / 1.8 m	Max towing gap / gap needing a red flag
300 mm / 1.8 m	Max load overhang at the front / rear

4.3 m / 2.5 m	Max load height / width
1 mm	Minimum tyre tread depth
24 hours	Report an accident to the police
0.05 / 0.02	g of alcohol per 100 ml of blood: ordinary / professional driver
3 to 14	Age of a 'child' for seatbelts, unless taller than 1.5 m